

4.3.4 Examples of choices of non-exam assessment texts and possible connections

1. John R. Reed (1973) has suggested that the 'unacknowledged crime' of Wilkie Collins' *The Moonstone* is the colonial guilt of the British Empire for its annexation of the entire Indian sub-continent rather than the theft of a single exquisite diamond.

Compare and contrast the presentation of British attitudes to race and ethnicity in *The Moonstone* and in Zadie Smith's *White Teeth* in the light of this view.

2. Compare and contrast the presentation of women in Keats' narrative poems 'Lamia', 'Isabella' and 'The Eve of St Agnes' with that of Anne Brontë's in her novel *The Tenant of Wildfell Hall*.

In what ways do you think the Gothic settings of these texts help the writers to shape their presentation of heroines in peril?

3. Sarah Waters has argued that the Victorian 'sensation novel' genre 'was at its best when tugging at the seams of certainties and easy solutions'.

Compare and contrast the presentation of Sue Trinder in *Fingersmith* with Marian Halcombe in *The Woman in White* in the light of this view.